7 Traps New Technical Leaders Fall Into

(and how to avoid them)

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1. Solving every technical problem yourself

You slow down your team growth and create bottlenecks.

The smarter move:

Trust your team.

Let them own their work, even if their approach is different from yours.

2. Prioritizing technical perfection over timely delivery

Striving for perfection delays progress, frustrates stakeholders, and demoralizes your team.

The smarter move:

Focus on delivering value on time and balance technical excellence with business needs.

3. Spending more time with code than with people

Trust erodes as team members feel unsupported and disconnected from their leader.

The smarter move:

Make time for meaningful conversations, build relationships and understand your team's needs.

4. Avoiding difficult conversations

Problems won’t get resolved on their own.

People never get a chance to improve. Top performers leave, tired of carrying extra weight.

The smarter move:

Approach tough topics early with empathy and curiosity.

Listen to understand and offer support.

5. Focusing only on what's broken

Technical minds often zero in on problems.

This approach overlooks people's progress and achievements.

The smarter move:

Celebrate contributions and wins.
Ensure your team feels valued.

6. Evaluating performance by lines of code

Your team will optimize for quantity over quality. Thoughtful work and non-coding contributions are undervalued.

The smarter move:

Measure success through outcomes, not output.

Evaluate impact, collaboration, and the quality of solutions.

7. Treating everyone's growth path as technical

People feel stuck and undervalued when their non-technical career goals, like leadership or design, are dismissed.

The smarter move:

Support diverse paths and aspirations.

Tailor growth plans to individual strengths and career goals.

Empower and uplift your team.

Be the leader you wish you had.

Share to help someone.

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